$300 quote $1,120 bill

RepairFair lets workshops send itemised quotes that drivers approve by text, so nothing reaches the bill without their OK.

One Sydney brake job	
Quoted	$300
Billed	$1,120
Typical price	$450–600

Typical price: front pads and rotors on small cars, booked online in Sydney (AutoGuru).

The problem

Repairs get approved without a clear record

Drivers can't check the bill

5 of 10 bills rose more than 10%

11 of 11 quotes showed labour as a lump sum

1 in 5 bad reviews: surprise bills, unapproved or unnecessary work

Workshops get stuck

3 of 10 struggle to reach customers, while cars wait on the hoist

2 of 10 lost money over disputed extras

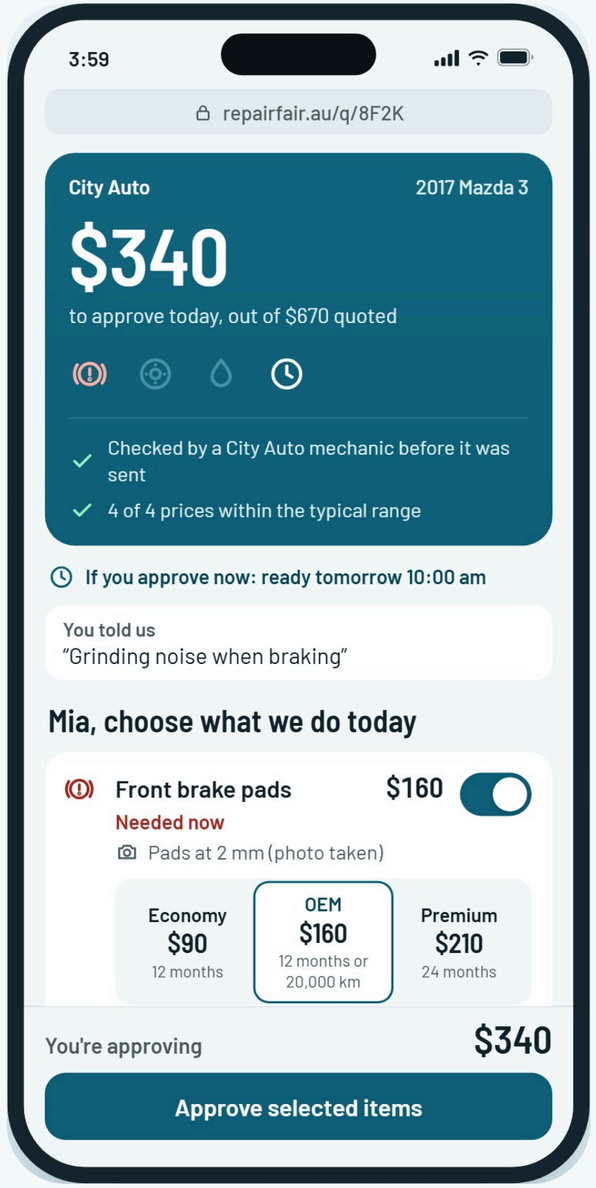
Felt most by owner-run independents with 1–5 mechanics

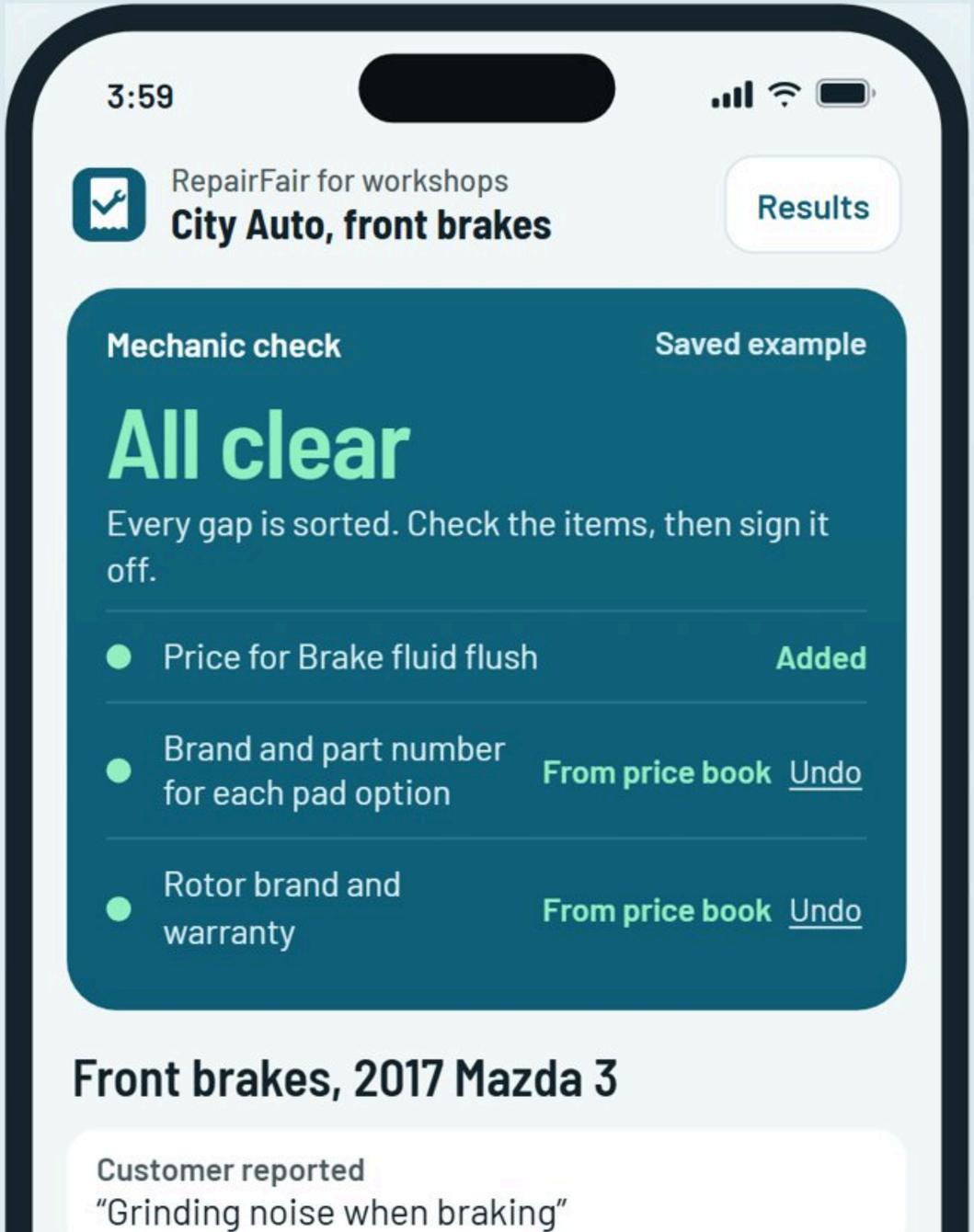
1 in 5: 1,079 one- and two-star Google reviews, 90 Sydney workshops. AI-coded; not checked by a person.

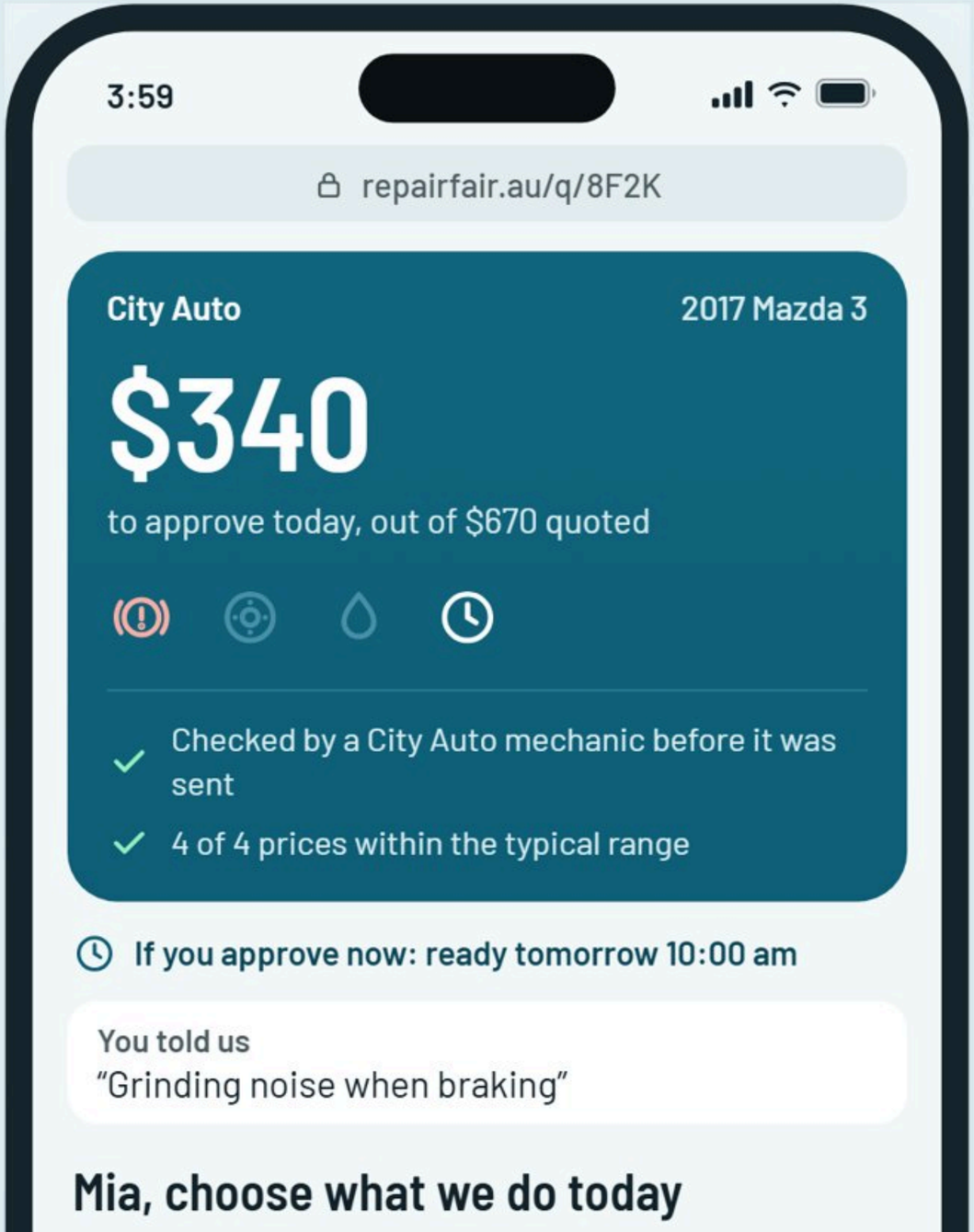
The solution

Clear, fair and in writing

1. AI turns a mechanic's rough notes into an itemised quote
2. The mechanic checks it, then sends it by text
3. The driver approves item by item, with no app
4. Extra work needs written approval too




3:59
RepairFair for workshops
City Auto, front brakes
Results
Mechanic check
Saved example
All clear
Every gap is sorted. Check the items, then sign it off.
Price for Brake fluid flush
Added
Brand and part number for each pad option
From price book
Undo
Rotor brand and warranty
From price book
Undo
Front brakes, 2017 Mazda 3
Customer reported
“Grinding noise when braking”


3:59
repairfair.au/q/8F2K
City Auto
2017 Mazda 3
$340
to approve today, out of $670 quoted
Checked by a City Auto mechanic before it was sent
4 of 4 prices within the typical range
If you approve now: ready tomorrow 10:00 am
You told us
“Grinding noise when braking”
Mia, choose what we do today

What we've learned so far

10 workshops shaped the product

6 of 10 would trial it free

4 of 10 would pay $29–79 a month

What changed after feedback

- Written approval of extras became the core
- A mechanic check before anything is sent
- AI drafting is optional, because some shops already quote in minutes

Working prototype. No pilot yet, and nobody has paid.

Competition

Keep your system. Add the part that gets the yes.

RepairFair
The approval step, from quote to final bill

What a workshop already uses
Paper, WeChat, MechanicDesk, Workshop Software

Full workshop systems	**about $85–120**
RepairFair add-on (planned)	**$49**

What makes us different

- ✔ Nothing to switch
- ✔ Helps the driver decide: urgency, part options and a plain reason on each item
- ✔ Rough notes become a quote the mechanic checks

A month, excluding GST, 30 Oct 2026. Some systems already offer customer approval. Details in backup.

Business model (planned)

One hour of follow-up work covers the month

A subscription. Workshops pay; drivers don't.

Free plan	**about 20 quotes a month**
Pro	**$49 a month**
Founding Inner West workshops	**first year free**

≈ $120 of work covers $49, if a workshop keeps about 40% after parts and wages

≈ $820k a year at 5% of 28,000 workshops

Both are estimates, not forecasts. 40% uses the closest ATO benchmark (automotive electrical). $820k is illustrative. Workshops: IBISWorld.

Go-to-market

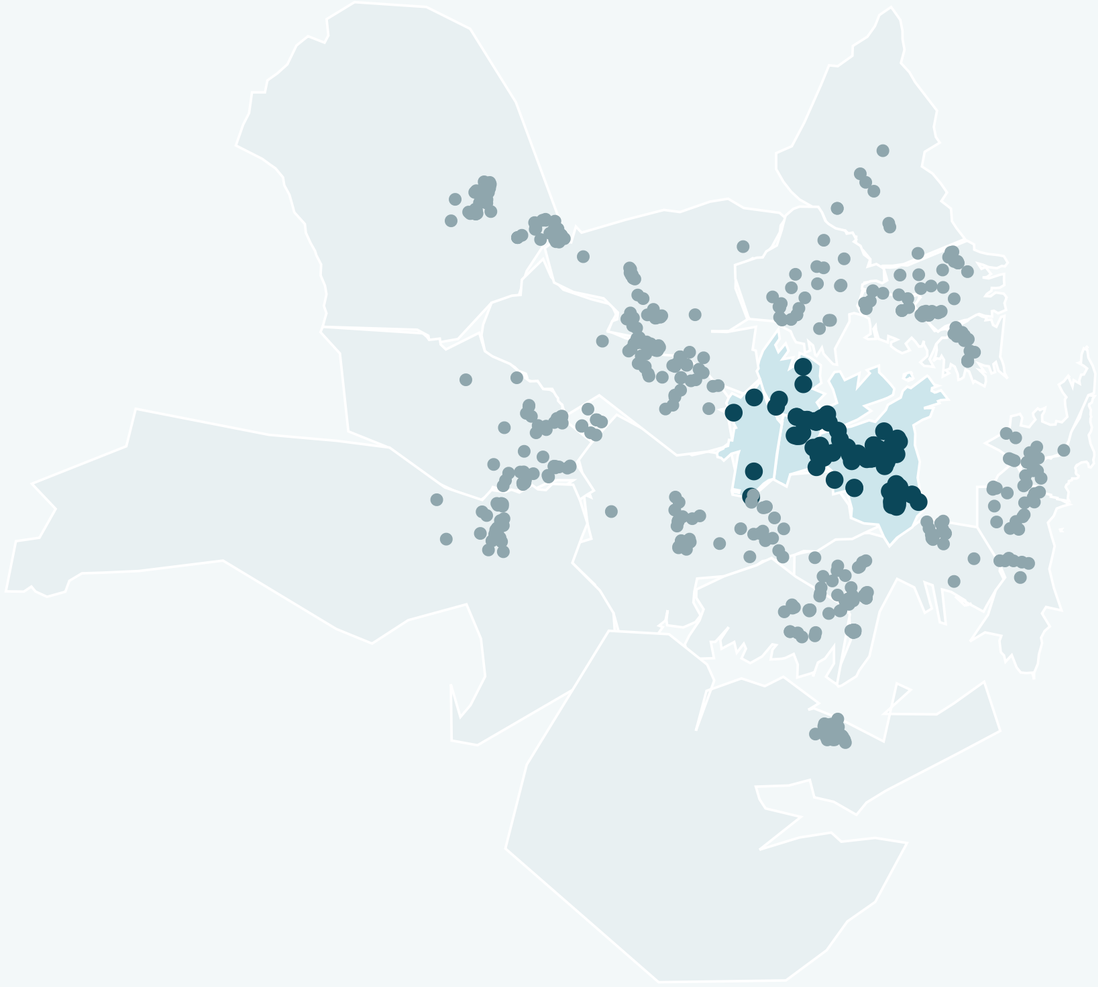
Start where garages sit close together

96 Inner West workshops found, 93 independent

607 across 21 Sydney councils

≈ 28,000 in Australia

Typically 26 other garages within 2 km. About $105 to sign one (estimate).



Workshops found in 30 Google Maps searches, so counts are minimums. National figure: IBISWorld.

Our ask

Help us run the first Inner West pilot

- 6 workshops for 3 months
- Half of quotes get a reply within 1 hour
- Every charge approved in writing
- 3 of 6 agree to pay $49 afterwards

Group 8, SIEN6007

ADD: team names and roles

ADD: contact email

ADD: QR code

Pilot goals, not predictions.

Backup

How the review study worked

Step	What we did
Sample	607 workshops found, 15 picked at random in each of 6 regions, from those with 5+ bad reviews
Reviews	Each workshop's 60 lowest-rated reviews; names removed; 1,079 one- and two-star reviews with text
Result	20.5% about bills, approval or unnecessary work (range 15–25%): 6% bills or approval, 16% unnecessary work, with some overlap
Coding	AI-coded (Claude). Two more AI coders agreed on 90–93% of a 60-review sample. Not checked by a person.
Fake reviews	Flagged, not deleted; 20.6% without them
Limits	A few workshops weigh heavily: 16% without the biggest three. Only workshops with several bad reviews. Bad reviews are about 7% of all reviews.

Backup

Workshop software prices

Product	Entry price a month, ex GST	Customer approval and texting
Workshop Software	Silver $119 ($99 yearly); Gold $149 ($119 yearly)	Gold and above: inspection link the customer opens to approve. Two-way texting add-on from $49
MechanicDesk	From $85	Texts at 10c each; customer approval not confirmed
Auxo Workshop	NZ$99	Not checked
RepairFair (planned)	Free plan, or Pro $49	Item-by-item approval by text link; works beside existing software

Public pricing pages, checked 30 Oct 2026. Recent startups also offer text approval inside a full system.

Backup

What's real in the prototype

Working

- AI quote from a mechanic's notes
- Suggested checks for the mechanic, not a diagnosis
- Mechanic check, price book and proof check
- Timestamped approvals in the app

Simulated or sample

- Both phones, texts and links
- Booking times
- Send to Xero (demo)
- Parts price ranges and Results figures

Backup

EV owners: a later opportunity

- About 1 in 10 Australian repairers are EV-certified (NRMA, 2026)
- More than 60% of EV owners worry about local access to a qualified repairer (NRMA, 2026)
- Many EV wear jobs don't need high-voltage work: tyres, brakes, suspension, 12V battery, alignment

Not part of the first pilot.

Backup

References

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6. ATO, small business benchmarks: automotive electrical services, 2023–24.
7. NSW Government, vehicle repairs and maintenance: nsw.gov.au.
8. ACMA, email and SMS unsubscribe rules: acma.gov.au.
9. Workshop Software, MechanicDesk and Auxo Workshop public pages, accessed 30 Oct 2026.
10. NRMA, EV repairer figures, 2026.